CIVICLENS · GOVTECH · INTERNAL

Interface Design Specification

Visual language, motion system, component library, and page-by-page screen design for the CivicLens regulatory intelligence platform.

VERSION 0.1 — DESIGN BASELINE

DRAWN 2026-05-31

AESTHETIC: DATA-AUTHORITY · LIGHT-DEFAULT

STACK: NEXT.JS · TAILWIND · GSAP

STATUS: FOR REVIEW

0 · How to read this document

This is the **visual and interaction specification** for CivicLens: what every screen looks like, how it behaves, and the exact tokens an engineer builds from. It is deliberately opinionated — pick it up and build, don't re-decide.

It is **not** the user-flow / information-architecture document. That is the next deliverable: a flow chart mapping every state transition, decision branch, and edge case end-to-end. This spec defines the *surface*; the flow doc defines the *plumbing*.

Decisions locked for this baseline

Dimension	Decision
Scope	Demo-first, built on a real design system that extends to full product (your `1C`)
Visual flavor	Data-authority — dense, data-forward, dark-capable (`2C`), defaulting to **light mode**
Color base	Cool neutral + navy/slate accent (`3A`)
Type	Sans for UI + monospace for data, citations, IDs (`4C`)
Motion	GSAP (`5B`), governed by hard restraint caps (§4)
Output	Spec text, no rendered mockups (`6A`)

> OPEN QUESTION CARRIED FORWARD
>
> The repo is named `nychack2026` but every jurisdiction in the product is Texas. If this ships to a NY audience, the diff screens and data sources need NY parity, or the product must explicitly frame Texas as a proof-state. **This spec is jurisdiction-agnostic** — city/state are data, not layout — so it survives either decision. Flagging so it doesn't get lost.

1 · Design principles

CivicLens sells trust in machine-generated legal-adjacent findings. Every visual decision either earns or spends that trust. These six principles resolve disputes when the spec is silent.

1.1 Credibility over delight

The product competes with a $500/hr lawyer and a midnight Google session. It must look like the lawyer, not the search box. When a choice is between "impressive" and "believable," choose believable. No gradients-as-decoration, no glassmorphism, no illustration mascots.

1.2 The citation is the hero

Every finding is only as trustworthy as its source link. Citations are not footnotes — they are first-class UI, always visible, always monospaced, always one tap from the source. A finding with no citation is never rendered (product rule, enforced in UI by never having a layout slot for an uncited finding).

1.3 Density is respect

Data-authority means we trust the user to handle information. We do not hide the dashboard behind progressive-disclosure wizards or oversized empty cards. Tight line-height, hairline dividers, real tables. But density ≠ clutter: whitespace is structural, used to group, never sprinkled.

1.4 Color is a signal, not a mood

The interface is 95% cool neutral. Color appears almost exclusively to carry meaning — navy for primary action and brand, and the three risk states (high / medium / low). If a colored element doesn't encode a state or an action, it's a bug.

1.5 Motion clarifies, never performs

Animation exists to show causality (this came from that), continuity (this is the same object moving), and status (this is loading / done). It never exists to entertain. See §4 for the hard caps that keep GSAP on a leash.

1.6 Honest states

Loading looks like loading, empty looks intentional, errors are specific and recoverable, and the legal disclaimer is never buried. We never fake data to look more complete, and we never imply certainty the RAG pipeline doesn't have.

2 · Design tokens

Single source of truth. Ship these as CSS custom properties (`--cl-*`) and map them into Tailwind's theme. Components reference tokens, never raw hex.

2.1 Color — light theme (default)

Neutrals (cool slate)

Token	Hex		Use
`--cl-canvas`	#F6F8FA		App background, behind all surfaces
`--cl-surface`	#FFFFFF		Cards, panels, table body, modals
`--cl-sunken`	#F1F4F7		Table headers, code blocks, inset wells
`--cl-border-subtle`	#E4E9EF		Row dividers, internal hairlines
`--cl-border`	#D3DAE3		Default component border
`--cl-border-strong`	#B6C0CC		Hover borders, input focus base
`--cl-text`	#11202E		Primary text, headings
`--cl-text-secondary`	#4A5B6B		Body secondary, labels
`--cl-text-muted`	#76828F		Captions, placeholders, metadata

Navy ramp (brand + primary action)

Token	Hex		Use
`--cl-navy-50`	#EEF3F8		Selected-row tint, info callout bg
`--cl-navy-100`	#D7E3F0		Secondary-button bg, chips
`--cl-navy-600`	#1F4D7A		**Primary action, links, brand**
`--cl-navy-700`	#163A5E		Primary hover, section rules
`--cl-navy-800`	#102B45		Primary active, table header bg
`--cl-navy-900`	#0B1F33		Top nav bar, footer, deepest text

Risk states (functional — desaturated on purpose)

State	Foreground	Tint bg	Border	Where
`HIGH`	`#B23A3A`	`#FBEDED`	`#E8C5C5`	Must-act findings, blocking permits
`MEDIUM`	`#9A6B16`	`#FBF3E3`	`#ECDBB4`	Should-act, deadline-driven
`LOW`	`#3F7A5A`	`#EAF3EE`	`#C4DECE`	Informational, good-to-know

These are intentionally muted brick / ochre / forest, not signal red/yellow/green. Saturated alert colors read as consumer-app urgency and undercut the institutional tone. They still pass as red/amber/green at a glance and are paired with a text label + icon, never color alone (accessibility).

2.2 Color — dark theme (capable secondary)

Same token names, remapped. Dark is opt-in via `data-theme="dark"`; light is the default everywhere a first-time / government user lands.

Token	Dark value	Note
`--cl-canvas`	#0B1320	Deep slate, not pure black
`--cl-surface`	#111B2B	
`--cl-sunken`	#0E1726	Darker than surface (inverted from light)
`--cl-border`	#28384E	
`--cl-text`	#E6ECF2	Never #FFF — reduces halation
`--cl-text-secondary`	#9DAEC0	
`--cl-navy-600` (primary)	#4E86C2	Brightened so action stays visible on dark
risk-high / med / low fg	#E07A7A / #D9A84A / #6FB58E	Lifted ~20% lightness; tints become #2A1718 / #2A2113 / #122318

2.3 Typography

UI sans: Inter (variable). **Data mono:** IBM Plex Mono (fallback JetBrains Mono). Mono is reserved — it signals "this is verbatim machine/source data": risk scores, classification output, citation URLs, record IDs, code, dates in tables.

Role	Size/LH	Weight	Family	Use
Display	40 / 44	600	Sans	Landing hero only
H1 / Page title	28 / 34	600	Sans	One per screen
H2 / Section	22 / 28	600	Sans	Dashboard section heads
H3 / Card title	18 / 24	600	Sans	Finding titles, panel heads
Body-lg	16 / 26	400	Sans	Explanations, prose
Body	15 / 23	400	Sans	Default UI text
Caption	13 / 20	400	Sans	Metadata, helper text
Label / Overline	12 / 16	600	Sans	Uppercase, +0.06em tracking, field labels
Data	14 / 22	400/500	**Mono**	Scores, IDs, dates-in-table, classification
Citation	12.5 / 20	400	**Mono**	Source URLs, agency refs

2.4 Spacing — 4px base scale

`2 · 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32 · 40 · 48 · 64 · 80 · 96`

Component internal padding defaults to 12–16px. Section gaps 24–32px. Page gutters 32px desktop, 16px mobile. Never use values off the scale.

2.5 Layout grid

Property	Value
Columns	12
Gutter	24px
Max content width (marketing)	1120px, centered
Max app width (dashboard)	1320px — wider, density-first
Breakpoints	sm 640 · md 768 · lg 1024 · xl 1280

2.6 Radius, borders, elevation

Data-authority leans crisp: hairline borders do the work, shadows are minimal. Radius is small and consistent.

Token	Value	Use
`--cl-radius-sm`	4px	Inputs, badges, chips
`--cl-radius`	6px	Default: cards, buttons
`--cl-radius-lg`	8px	Modals, drawers
border width	1px	All borders. Table cells may go borderless with row dividers only
`--cl-elev-1`	0 1px 2px rgba(16,32,48,.06)	Resting card lift
`--cl-elev-2`	0 4px 12px rgba(16,32,48,.10)	Dropdown, popover, tooltip
`--cl-elev-3`	0 12px 32px rgba(16,32,48,.16)	Drawer, modal scrim partner

2.7 Motion tokens

Token	Value	Use
`--cl-dur-instant`	80ms	Hover color, press
`--cl-dur-fast`	140ms	Focus ring, tooltip, toggle
`--cl-dur-base`	200ms	Default — most transitions
`--cl-dur-slow`	320ms	Drawer / panel slide (hard ceiling for interactive)
`--cl-dur-entrance`	480ms	First-load orchestration only
`--cl-dur-count`	700ms	Risk-score number count-up (numbers are the one exception)
`--cl-ease-standard`	cubic-bezier(.4,0,.2,1)	GSAP `power2.out`
`--cl-ease-in`	cubic-bezier(.4,0,1,1)	Exits — `power2.in`

`--cl-ease-out`	cubic-bezier(0,0,.2,1)	Entrances — `power3.out`

BANNED EASINGS

No `elastic`, `back`, or `bounce` anywhere in the product. They read as toy-like and are incompatible with the institutional tone. GSAP default config should set `defaults:{ease:"power2.out", duration: 0.2}`.

2.8 Iconography

Lucide icon set. Stroke 1.5px, sizes 16 / 20 / 24. Icons are line, never filled-decorative. Always paired with text in primary actions; icon-only allowed only in dense toolbars with a tooltip.

3 · Light / dark strategy

Light is the default and the demo theme. Dark exists for power users running the dashboard for hours, and is the reason data-authority was chosen — but it must never be where a government evaluator first lands.

- **Default:** light. No system-preference auto-switch on first load (a gov user on a dark-mode OS should still see the trustworthy light UI first).
- **Toggle:** a single control in the top-nav (sun/moon, 16px). Persists to `localStorage` in production; in the hackathon build it can be session-only React state.
- **Implementation:** one `data-theme` attribute on `<html>` flips the CSS-var block. No component knows which theme it's in.
- **Demo guidance:** present in light. If asked about dark, toggle it live for one beat — it demonstrates polish without risking the read.

4 · Motion system (GSAP, on a leash)

GSAP gives precise timelines and ScrollTrigger — useful for staggered table reveals and score count-ups. It is also the easiest way to turn a serious tool into a slot machine. These caps are non-negotiable; treat them as lint rules.

4.1 Hard caps

1. **One hero entrance per page load.** Everything else is ≤200ms. No screen has two competing "look at me" animations.
2. **Stagger is clamped.** Max 0.04s between items, and total stagger time capped at **0.4s regardless of item count** (use GSAP `stagger:{each:0.04, amount:0.4}` — `amount` divides total time across all items). 50 table rows must not take 2 seconds to appear.
3. **No infinite motion** except (a) one skeleton shimmer, (b) one indeterminate progress bar. Nothing pulses, breathes, or floats at rest.
4. **ScrollTrigger is for one-time reveals only.** Below-fold dashboard sections fade+rise 12px, once, ≤200ms. No parallax, no scrubbing, no pinning, no scroll-jacking.
5. **Motion never blocks input.** Buttons are clickable, links navigable, and content selectable before any animation finishes.
6. **`prefers-reduced-motion`** collapses everything to opacity-only at 120ms, or instant. Count-ups jump to final value. This is wired globally via a GSAP matchMedia guard, not per-component.

4.2 Microinteraction catalog

Interaction	Property	Duration	Easing / note
Button hover	bg + border color	80ms	standard; no scale/lift
Button press	translateY 1px	80ms	tactile, returns on release
Input focus	border + 2px ring	140ms	ring = navy-400 @ 40% + 2px offset
Card/row hover	border-strong + bg navy-50	120ms	cursor pointer only if interactive
Finding rows enter	opacity 0→1, y 8→0	200ms	power3.out, clamped stagger
Risk score	count 0→N	700ms	power1.out; the deliberate exception
Citation drawer	slide-in from right	320ms	power2.out; scrim fades 200ms
Tab switch	underline slide + content x-fade	160ms	underline is the continuity cue
Diff cells	highlight wash on load	200ms	changed cells get one tint pulse, then settle
Toast	rise 12px + fade	200ms in / 160 out	auto-dismiss 5s; pauses on hover
Skeleton → content	cross-fade	160ms	shimmer stops the instant data lands

4.3 Explicitly banned

Page-transition wipes · confetti / celebration · animated gradients · parallax · auto-playing carousels · hover-scale on cards · spinning logos · typing-effect text · anything that loops at rest.

5 · Core components

Atoms and molecules every screen reuses. Each lists anatomy, sizing, and states. Build these once in `/components/ui`.

5.1 Button

Variants: Primary (navy-600 bg, white text), Secondary (surface bg, border, navy-700 text), Ghost (transparent, navy-700 text), Destructive (risk-high). **Sizes:** sm 28px / md 36px / lg 44px tall; horizontal pad 12 / 16 / 20. Radius 6. **States:** default, hover (darken one navy step), active (press 1px), focus (ring), disabled (40% opacity, no pointer), loading (inline 14px spinner replaces leading icon, label stays).

5.2 Text input & intake textarea

Border `--cl-border`, radius 4, height 40 (input) / auto-grow (textarea, min 96px). Focus → border-strong + navy ring. The **intake textarea** is the product's front door: 16px text, generous 16px padding, monospace placeholder showing an example query, a character-count-free design (don't make compliance feel rationed), and a primary "Analyze" button docked bottom-right inside the field frame.

5.3 Card / Panel

Surface bg, 1px border, radius 6, padding 16. Optional header row (H3 + right-aligned action) separated by a subtle hairline. Resting elevation-1. Cards do not lift on hover unless they are a clickable navigation target.

5.4 Data table (dense)

Navy-800 header, white text, 8px cell padding, row dividers in `--cl-border-subtle`, zebra optional (canvas on even). Numeric/date/ID cells use mono. Row hover → navy-50. Sortable headers show a 12px chevron on hover. This is the diff viewer's backbone.

5.5 Risk badge

Pill, mono 12px, uppercase, tint bg + matching border + foreground from §2.1. Always `[icon] LABEL` — triangle-alert (high), clock (medium), info (low). Never communicates risk by color alone.

5.6 Citation chip

The signature component. Mono 12.5px, navy-700 text, link-underline on hover, a 12px external-link icon trailing, and the *agency name* as visible label with the full URL on hover/expand. Lives attached to every finding. Clicking opens the citation drawer (§6.5), not a new tab by default — keep the user in-context, offer "open source ↗" inside the drawer.

5.7 Tabs, Tooltip, Toast, Skeleton

Tabs: text labels, 2px navy underline on active, sliding underline on switch.
Tooltip: navy-900 bg, white, 12px, 6px pad, 140ms fade, 400ms open delay.
Toast: bottom-center, surface bg + left status border, elevation-2, auto-dismiss 5s.
Skeleton: sunken blocks with a single left-to-right shimmer; matches the exact layout of the content it replaces (never a generic spinner for the dashboard).

5.8 Disclaimer banner

Persistent, low-key, never dismissible on results screens: *"Informational guidance, not legal advice."* Sits as a thin bar under the dashboard header — navy-50 bg, navy-700 text, info icon. Required by the product guardrails; design makes it present-but-not-alarming.

6 · Screen-by-screen specification

Each screen: purpose, layout regions (with measurements), components, content/copy, states, motion, responsive. Demo-critical screens (intake, dashboard, diff) are speced deepest; system states are speced because "real product" (1C) needs them.

6.1 Landing page

Purpose: Convert a skeptical, possibly non-technical business owner in one scroll. Establish credibility before asking for input.

```
TOP NAV (64px, navy-900)   [ CivicLens wordmark ]            [ How it works ] [ Sources ]
[ theme ]  [ Try it ]
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
HERO (centered, max 720px)
   overline:  REGULATORY INTELLIGENCE FOR TEXAS BUSINESS
   display:   "Know every rule that applies to your
               business. Before it costs you."
   sub:       one sentence, body-lg, text-secondary
   [ Primary: Run a free risk scan ]   [ Ghost: See a live example ]
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
TRUST STRIP   "Sources we read:" + 6 agency wordmarks/labels in mono, muted
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
HOW IT WORKS  3 columns: Describe → Map → Act  (icon + H3 + 2 lines each)
PROOF         the real human story (quote card, attributed, with the $ figure)
FOOTER (navy-900)   disclaimer line + sources + minimal links
```

Components: top-nav, button (primary/ghost), trust strip (mono labels), 3-up feature cards, quote card. **Motion:** ONE hero entrance — overline → headline → sub → buttons fade+rise, 480ms total, clamped stagger; trust strip and sections use ScrollTrigger one-time reveal. **Copy tone:** plain, declarative, dollar-specific. No marketing fluff, no "revolutionary." **Responsive:** 3-up collapses to stack at md; nav → hamburger at sm.

6.2 Intake screen

Purpose: Get the business described in natural language with zero form friction. This is Feature A.

```
HEADER     H1 "Describe your business"   ·   caption "Plain English. No forms."
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
INTAKE FIELD (max 720px, centered)
   large auto-grow textarea, mono placeholder:
   "I own a food truck in Dallas with 3 employees. I want to open a
    brick-and-mortar restaurant in Austin and add alcohol service."
   docked button (bottom-right inside frame):  [ Analyze → ]
   helper row below:  "Try an example:" + 3 ghost chips (the validated scenarios)
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
DISCLAIMER strip (subtle, bottom)
```

States: empty (placeholder + example chips) · typing (button enables at ~>15 chars) · submitting (button → spinner, field locks, "Reading regulations…" caption) · error (field unlocks, inline message, retry). **Motion:** field focus ring 140ms; on submit the field doesn't navigate — it morphs in place into the classification panel (continuity). **Demo note:** example chips guarantee the validated path; clicking one fills the textarea verbatim.

6.3 Classification review

Purpose: Show what the system understood and let the user confirm/correct before committing to analysis. Builds trust by being transparent about interpretation.

```
PANEL (slides up from intake field)
   overline: WE READ THIS AS  ·  edit affordance (pencil) top-right
   mono key/value block (editable chips):
      industry        food_service
      location        Dallas, TX
      expansion       Austin, TX
      activities      food_preparation, alcohol_planned
      employees       3
   [ Looks right — analyze ]   [ Ghost: edit ]
```

Components: mono KV block, editable chips (click → inline input), primary/ghost buttons. **Why it exists:** a wrong classification silently producing wrong findings is the worst trust failure; this gate prevents it. **Motion:** KV rows reveal with clamped stagger, 200ms. **Skip rule:** in the demo, classification is high-confidence so this can auto-confirm after a 600ms beat — but the panel still shows, so judges see the interpretation.

6.4 Risk dashboard — the hero screen

Purpose: Feature B. The single screen that has to land in the demo. Personalized, prioritized, cited.

```
APP HEADER (navy-900, 56px)  [ wordmark ]  business summary chip  ·  [ Compare ▢ ]
[ theme ]
DISCLAIMER BAR (navy-50, 28px)  ⓘ Informational guidance, not legal advice.
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
SUMMARY ROW  (3 cards, equal)
   ┌ RISK SCORE ──┐  ┌ FINDINGS ───┐  ┌ TOP PRIORITY ─┐
   │   72 / 100   │  │ 8 total     │  │ TABC license  │
   │  mono, big   │  │ 3H · 4M · 1L│  │ HIGH · blocks │
   └──────────────┘  └─────────────┘  └───────────────┘
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
FINDINGS LIST  (single column, sorted High→Low)
   each FINDING ROW:
     [HIGH badge]  Title (H3)                              [ source chip ]
     one-line explanation (body)            recommended action (muted)
     ▸ expand → full explanation + all citations
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
RIGHT RAIL (optional, ≥xl)  filters by jurisdiction / risk level / area
```

Components: summary cards, risk-score count-up, finding rows, risk badges, citation chips, filter rail. **Layout:** app max 1320px; findings column ~760px, rail ~280px. **Motion (the one place it matters):** on load — score counts 0 → 72 (700ms), then finding rows reveal with clamped stagger (total ≤0.4s) High-first so the eye lands on what's urgent. Nothing else moves. **States:** loading (skeleton mirroring this exact layout) · no-findings (rare, intentional empty state, not an error) · partial (some sources failed → banner "2 sources unavailable, results may be incomplete" — honesty principle). **Responsive:** rail drops below findings at lg; summary cards stack at sm.

6.5 Finding detail / citation drawer

Purpose: Deliver the trust payload — the actual source behind a finding.

```
DRAWER (right, 420px, slides 320ms, scrim behind)
   [HIGH]  Finding title (H2)
   WHAT THIS MEANS    plain-English body-lg
   WHAT TO DO         numbered steps
   WHY / SOURCE       mono citation block:
        ▸ TABC — Mixed Beverage Permit Requirements
          tabc.texas.gov/permits/...        [ open source ↗ ]
          "retrieved 2026-05-30 · §..."
   [ Mark as handled ]  (real-product affordance, hidden in demo)
```

Components: drawer, scrim, citation block, step list. **Motion:** drawer slide 320ms power2.out, scrim fade 200ms; closes on scrim-click / Esc. **Rule:** if a finding somehow has no citation, the drawer's SOURCE section is replaced by a visible "Source unavailable — finding withheld" and the finding should never have rendered (defense in depth).

6.6 Diff viewer — the differentiator

Purpose: Feature C. Side-by-side regulatory comparison across scenarios/cities. The "wow" beat of the demo.

```
HEADER   H1 "Dallas food truck  →  Austin restaurant + beer garden"
         scenario switcher (segmented control)
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
DIFF TABLE (dense data table)
   ┌ Requirement ───────┬ Dallas (now) ─┬ Austin (planned) ─┬ Δ ───────┐
   │ Health permit      │ County DCHHS  │ Austin APH        │ CHANGED │
   │ Alcohol (TABC)     │ —             │ Mixed Bev required│ NEW     │
   │ Zoning / outdoor   │ n/a           │ CUP for beer grdn │ NEW     │
   │ Sales tax permit   │ Comptroller   │ Comptroller       │ SAME    │
   └────────────────────┴───────────────┴───────────────────┴─────────┘
   each row: every non-empty cell carries its own source chip
   LEGEND   ● NEW   ● CHANGED   ● SAME    + [ Print / Save comparison ]
```

Δ coding: NEW = risk-high tint, CHANGED = risk-med tint, SAME = neutral. Tint applies to the Δ cell only, not the whole row (density without noise). **Motion:** on load, changed/new cells get ONE highlight wash (200ms) then settle — shows the user what moved, then gets out of the way. No re-triggering on scroll. **States:** only manually-validated scenarios are selectable (guardrail — no made-up diffs); switcher shows validated scenarios only. **Print:** a real print stylesheet (acceptance criteria: "I can print or save the comparison") — strips nav, expands all citations inline as footnotes.

6.7 Compliance Pulse — email mock

Purpose: Feature D. Show the ongoing-monitoring value as a static, realistic email preview.

```
EMAIL FRAME (max 600px, rendered as it'd land in an inbox)
   from: CivicLens    subj: 2 updates for your Austin restaurant
   ─────────────────────────────────────────
   header band (navy-900, wordmark)
   "This week we found 2 changes that affect you."
   • [MED] Austin updated outdoor-service hours — review       [ View ↗ ]
   • [LOW] Franchise tax filing window opens June 15           [ View ↗ ]
   footer: unsubscribe · "Informational, not legal advice."
```

Note: explicitly a mock — built as static HTML email markup (tables, inline styles) so it's also a real artifact later. Uses the same risk badges and disclaimer for consistency. No animation (it's an email). **Demo framing:** "this is what lands in your inbox every Monday."

6.8 System states (required for real-product scope)

State	Design
Global loading	Layout-matching skeletons, never a centered spinner. Shimmer stops on data arrival, cross-fade 160ms.
Empty (no findings)	Intentional, calm: icon + "No high-risk findings for this profile." + "Here's what we checked" (lists the sources read). Reassurance, not a dead end.
Partial / degraded	Results show + amber banner naming which sources failed. Never silently hide that coverage was incomplete.
Error	Specific + recoverable: what failed, a retry button, and a fallback ("try the example scenario"). Never a raw stack trace or a generic "something went wrong."
Rate-limited / cold start	Honest copy ("warming up the model, ~10s") with the indeterminate bar — the only other allowed infinite motion.

7 · Accessibility

- **Never color-only:** every risk state pairs color with an icon and a text label. Diff Δ states the same.
- **Contrast:** body text ≥ 4.5:1, large text ≥ 3:1, in both themes. Muted text (#76828F on #F6F8FA) is verified ~4.6:1 — do not lighten further.
- **Focus:** visible 2px ring on every interactive element; logical tab order; drawer/modal trap focus and return it on close.
- **Motion:** `prefers-reduced-motion` honored globally (§4.1.6).
- **Semantics:** findings are a list, the diff is a real `<table>` with headers, citations are real links with descriptive text (not "click here").
- **Target size:** interactive targets ≥ 40px on touch.

8 · Implementation notes

Concern	Approach
Tokens	CSS custom properties on `:root` + `[data-theme="dark"]`; mapped into `tailwind.config` theme.extend so utilities resolve to vars.
Fonts	Inter + IBM Plex Mono via `next/font` (self-hosted, no FOUT, no external request — also a privacy nicety for a gov tool).
GSAP	One `gsap.config` + a `useGsapContext` wrapper; `gsap.matchMedia` for reduced-motion; ScrollTrigger imported only on pages that use it (landing) to keep the dashboard bundle lean.
Components	Headless primitives (Radix) for drawer/tabs/tooltip → accessibility for free; style with tokens.
Performance	Dashboard is the critical path — server-render the shell, stream findings, skeletons cover the gap. Count-up only fires after data is real (never animate to a placeholder).
Print	Dedicated print stylesheet for the diff viewer (acceptance criteria); expands citations to footnotes, hides chrome.

9 · Next deliverable

This spec defines the surface. The companion document is the **user-flow & UX map** you asked for — built next.

It will cover, to the state-transition level: entry points → intake → classification (confirm / correct / re-enter) → analysis (loading / success / partial / error) → dashboard → finding drawer → diff → print/save → (real-product) save profile / monitoring opt-in. Every branch, every back-path, every dead-end and its recovery. Rendered as a single flow chart plus a state table, so engineering can read it as a spec and you can read it as a story.

> BEFORE THE FLOW DOC, TWO INPUTS FROM YOU
>
> (1) Confirm whether the flow should include the real-product paths (auth, saved profiles, monitoring opt-in) or stay demo-scoped. (2) Resolve the NY-vs-Texas question so the diff flow uses the right jurisdictions. Neither blocks me starting — I'll default to "demo flow + real paths marked optional, Texas data" unless you say otherwise.